

Rouzhi Liang

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Education

Ph.D. Economics, Southern Methodist University	2026
M.S. Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2018
B.A. Economics, Beihang University	2016

Research Interests

Macroeconomics and Growth, Family Economics, Culture, Entrepreneurship

Working Papers

Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship (*Job Market Paper*) ([PDF](#))

This paper studies how parental fertility and bequest decisions influence children's ability to become entrepreneurs in the presence of financial frictions.

Individualism and Innovation: Unraveling Culture's Influence Across Time ([PDF](#))

This paper examines the impact of individualism on innovation and economic development over time, both cross-country and within the US.

Research in Progress

Finance, Demographic Transition, and Structural Change

Multiple Entrepreneurial Talent Misallocation with [Javier Gonzalez](#)

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Wookun Kim	2020
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- Processed and analyzed NASA satellite-based pollution data using Python and QGIS

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Michael Sposi	2022
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- Collected and cleaned world import and export data
- Used Stata to compute descriptive statistics

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Daniel L. Millimet	2024
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- Collected and cleaned Census data
- Constructed and replicated county-level trade shock data

Teaching Experience

Instructor: Intermediate Macroeconomics (SMU, Summer 2023)

Teaching Assistant: Macroeconomic Theory I (PhD), Microeconomic Theory I & II (PhD), Strategic Behavior (Master), Economic Analysis I & II (Master), International Macroeconomic Theory and Policy (UG), Price Theory (UG)

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2024
<i>Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship</i> (Graduate Student Award)	
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2023
<i>Individualism and Innovation: Unraveling Culture's Influence Across Time</i>	
SMU Research and Innovation Week	2023
<i>Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship</i>	

Skills

Programming	Python, Stata, QGIS, L ^A T _E X
Language	English (Fluent), Mandarin (Native)

Fellowship & Awards

Provost's Doctoral Candidacy Fellowship, Southern Methodist University (2023-Present)
Graduate Fellowship, Southern Methodist University (2019-2023)
Graduate Student Award, 2024 Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

Leadership & Outreach

SMU Dedman Graduate Student Assembly, Representative for the Economics Department (2023-2025)
SMU Dedman Graduate Student Assembly, President (2025-2026)
Moody School Graduate Student Advisory Member from Dedman College (2025-2026)

References

Dr. Ömer Özak (Advisor)

Associate Professor of Economics, Southern Methodist University
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Dr. Klaus Desmet

Ruth and Kenneth Altshuler Centennial Interdisciplinary Professor, Southern Methodist University
Email: kdesmet@mail.smu.edu

Dr. Michael Sposi

Associate Professor and Director of Doctoral Studies, Southern Methodist University
Email: msposi@mail.smu.edu

Dr. Rocío Madera

Assistant Professor of Economics, Southern Methodist University
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